

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

(This is a two-page report. Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.)

Each table cell will automatically enlarge as you type!

Red 2/5/01 wpl

CFO-RC FILE X:

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name): **BLACKBURNIAN WARBLER**(Scientific Name) *Dendroica fusca*Date(s) of occurrence: **20 May 2000**Number of birds seen: **One**Sex: **Female**Plumage: **Adult**Exact Location: **Southwest corner of Crow Valley Campground**County: **Weld**Nearest town: **Briggsdale**Elevation: **4900 msl**Length of observation: **Roughly 3 minutes**Time(s) of observation: **Approximately 9:10 AM MDST**

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you:

Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s):

Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position: **Overcast**Optical equipment used: **8x40 Binoculars**Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): **30 - 50 feet**Was bird(s) photographed? **No**

If so, have you submitted photos?

Who took the photographs?

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: **Riparian thicket along stream.**Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the Species or in supporting the identification): **Actively foraging in trees/shrubs.**

Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes):

A typical *Dendroica* with relatively long wings and body, moderate-sized tail, relatively thick bill (for a warbler) and unlike the long, thin bills of *Vermivora*.

The bird was observed actively foraging in treetops. The bill appeared mostly dark but may have been a little lighter on the lower mandible. The crown was a dark grayish-black. A blackish eyeline emanated from the bill and extended posteriorly through the eye to the nape. The auriculars were grayish and contrasted with the remainder of the face. The face was mostly a bright yellowish orange; the throat was almost a complete dull orange. A yellowish-orange supercilium was noticeable and was relatively thick. The breast was mostly yellowish-orange except for some grayish diffused streaking that extended through the flanks. The belly, flanks, and vent were white. The back and wings had a dark gray basal color with black streaking across the nape and black edges to the coverts and secondaries. Two large white wingbars were present on the coverts. The tail was mostly a dark gray but flashed white on the outer rectrices when in flight.

Describe bird's call or song: **None heard**

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them:

The small size (approximately 5 inches in length) eliminates all orioles. The yellowish coloration of the face, throat and breast eliminate most warblers except for Magnolia, Yellow-throated, Cape May, and Townsend's (female).

Magnolia is eliminated due to the fact that the face is mostly blackish with a gray crown and white supercilium. The yellow on the throat and breast of a Magnolia extend further rearward throughout the flanks and belly. The breast contains heavy black streaking on a Magnolia. The white wingbars on a Magnolia are also much thinner and may be joined by a silvery patch that may make it appear to be a single wingbar.

Yellow-throated Warblers are much longer-billed, lack the yellow on the face (except for the upper throat and lores), possess a white, not yellow supercilium, have a blackish triangular patch below the eye, and would show a white nape area.

Adult male Cape May Warblers lack the extensive yellow supercilium. A bright rusty face patch extends from portions of the supercilium ventrally through the auriculars. The breast of a Cape May Warbler is more heavily streaked and instead of two white wing bars, would portray large white patch through the greater coverts.

Female Townsend's appear most similar to female Blackburnian Warblers. However, Townsend's differ in having more of a greener basal color overall. The lores of a Townsend's are deeper. The crown and mantle are a dark olive-green compared to the very dark gray/black of a Blackburnian. The flanks of a Townsend's contain more yellowish/green/gray and look smudgy instead of the clean white flanks of a Blackburnian. The sides of the upper breast of a female Townsend's usually show a small black patch in which the black streaking of the flanks emanates from.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? Have observed countless others in Wisconsin and Minnesota while on the breeding grounds and in migration. Have also observed Blackburnians in migration on the Texas coast. Have banded numerous birds in the Upper Midwest.

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): None

This report is from notes made during or after XX observation or later from memory

Date of written report: 12/26/00

Reporting observer: Larry Semo

Signature:



Reporting Observer's Address: 9054 Dover Street

City: Westminster

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Zip: 80021

Send report to:
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